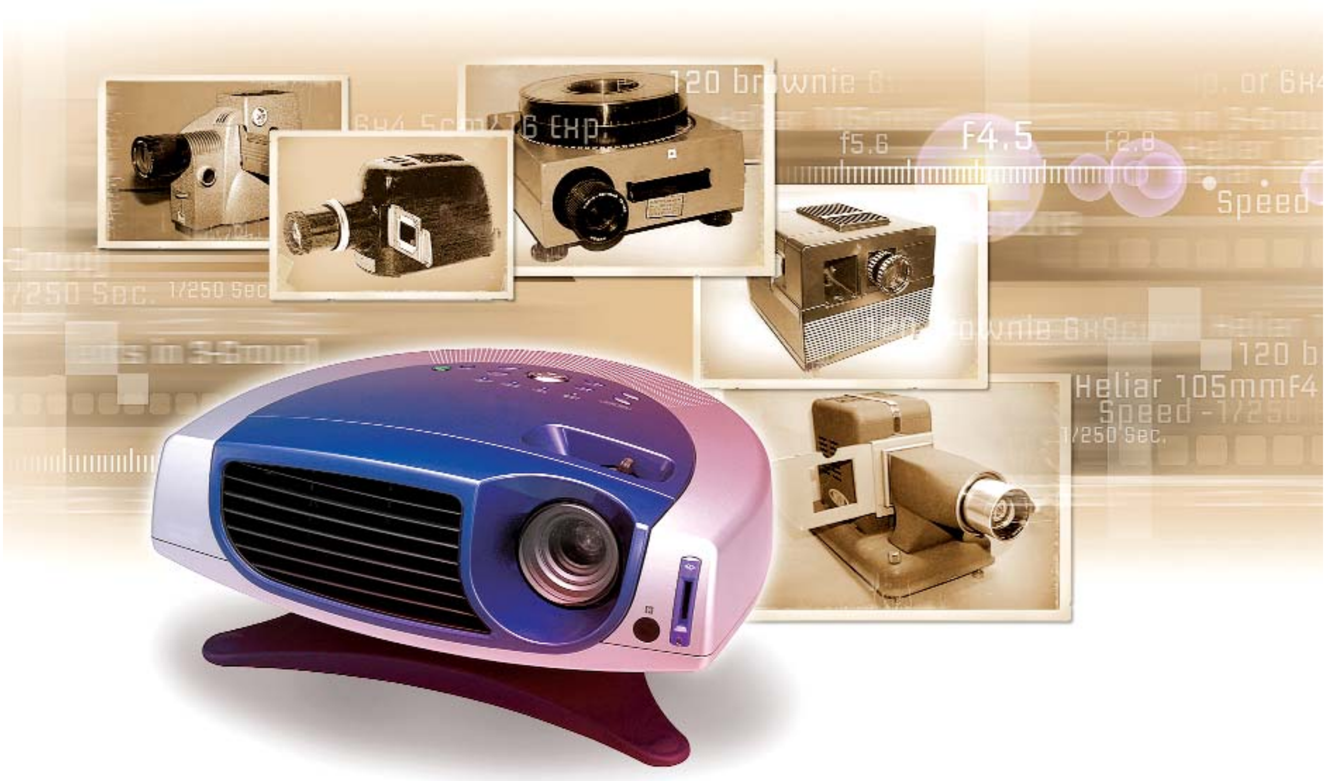


Get The Big Picture

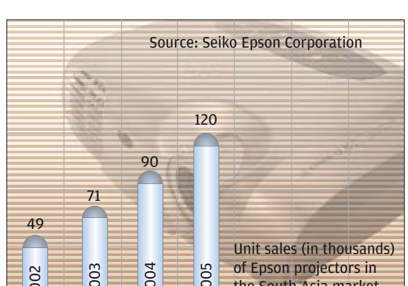
Projectors are set to go mass this year with both businesses and homes adopting them

Meera Venkipuram

It all started 18 months ago when prices of projectors started falling. The Indian market, like many of its south Asian counterparts, is extremely price sensitive, and projectors did not catch on in the market not because they were not good, but because they were expensive. Not anymore, though.

These days, educational institutions, business-small and big, and even home users (who want them for home entertainment systems) are lapping up projectors. Naturally, the price-fall has resulted in higher demand for both LCD and DLP systems, the two kinds of technologies used in projectors.

Studies indicate that between DLP (Digital Light Processing) and LCD (Liquid Crystal Display), DLP projectors remain intact after 2000 hours of viewing time, while LCD displays deteriorate-the light source necessarily has to be replaced.



LCD and DLP Explained

An LCD display is essentially electrically controlled light-polarising liquid trapped in cells between two transparent polarising sheets, placed perpendicular to each other. The cells possess electrical contacts that allow an electric field to be applied to the liquid inside. LCD ensures superior picture quality with minimum radiation.

DLP technology was originally developed by US-based IT products manufacturer Texas Instruments, though licenses are issued to several manufacturers to market products based on their chipsets.

In DLP projectors, images are created by microscopic mirrors laid out on a semiconductor chip, the Digital Micromirror Device (DMD). These mirrors spin rapidly to reflect